

YOUNG BOSS CARIBBEAN KITCHEN GUIDE

How Caribbean Kids Turn Home
Cooking Into a **Real** Food Business

Cook It.
Package It.
Sell It.

YOUNG
BOSS

YOUNG
BOSS

MADE WITH LOVE.
MADE TO GROW.

YOUNG
BOSS

JERK CHICKEN
BOLD, AUTHENTIC, CARIBBEAN.

YOUNG
BOSS

RICE & PEAS
CARIBBEAN CLASSIC.

YOUNG
BOSS

SWEET PLANTAINS
MADE WITH LOVE.

FOR KIDS
WITH BIG
IDEAS AND
EVEN BIGGER
GOALS



➔ CaribStream.io ⇐

Young Boss Caribbean Kitchen Guide

How Caribbean Kids Turn Home Cooking Into a Real Food Business

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EARNING BENCHMARKS

\$200–\$500 per weekend selling 20–40 plates · meal prep subscribers pay weekly in advance · catering events \$500–\$1,500 each · Caribbean food demand in diaspora cities far exceeds supply

Why Caribbean Food Is Your Built-In Business Advantage

The diaspora is hungry for authentic Caribbean food. You already know how to make it.

Caribbean food in diaspora cities is one of the most underserved food markets in the world. The Jamaican restaurant has a 45-minute wait every Friday night. The Trinidadian roti shop closes at 2pm. The Guyanese pepperpot that your grandmother makes every Sunday does not exist on any delivery app, in any restaurant, or at any market stall within 10 miles of where most Caribbean families live. And yet every Caribbean family in the diaspora craves it constantly. That gap between the food people want and the food that is available is your business.

\$400

Average weekend revenue selling 20 plates at \$20 each · catering events add \$500–\$1,500 · meal prep subscribers pay weekly in advance · zero competition for authentic Caribbean home cooking

Your Unfair Advantage

You grew up in a Caribbean kitchen. You watched your parents, grandparents, and aunties cook. You know how jerk chicken is supposed to smell when it is right. You know how pepperpot is supposed to taste when the cassareep is properly balanced. You know the difference between real curry goat and a generic curry with goat in it. That knowledge — which you received for free just by being Caribbean — is worth real money to the diaspora community around you that is hungry for exactly what you know how to make.

What you are selling

Authentic Caribbean home cooking — the food your community grew up eating and cannot find anywhere else. Not a restaurant version. Not a generic version. The real thing. Made the way their grandmother made it.

Why people pay premium prices for it

Authenticity is scarce. A plate of real jerk chicken with rice and peas and festival, made correctly, is worth \$18–\$22 to a Caribbean family in Brooklyn, Toronto, or London. They know what the real thing tastes like. They will pay for it every time you make it available.

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Jamaica is the birthplace of jerk seasoning — a cooking technique developed by the Maroons that spread across the entire world. The food your community invented is now sold everywhere. But the authentic version, made the Caribbean way by a Caribbean family, is rare. That rarity is your advantage.

Your Menu — What Sells, What Travels, What Earns

The dishes that photograph well, travel well, and sell on repeat.

Start with 4–6 dishes maximum. Too many options slow down your cooking and increase your food waste. Lead with your 2–3 strongest dishes — the ones you cook best and that photograph beautifully. Your menu should be short enough to execute perfectly and specific enough to make people excited when they see it.

The Caribbean Young Boss Core Menu

1	Jerk Chicken Plate — Your Anchor Dish Jerk chicken with rice and peas and festival or fried dumpling. This is the plate every Caribbean family wants and every non-Caribbean customer is curious about. It travels perfectly in a sealed container. It photographs beautifully — the caramelized skin, the steam, the bright festival. Price: \$18–\$22 per plate. Food cost: \$5–\$7. Margin: 65–75%.
2	Curry Goat or Curry Chicken — Your Second Seller Rich, saucy, deeply flavored. Serve with white rice or roti. Curry goat commands premium pricing (\$22–\$26) because goat is harder to source and requires skill to cook properly. Curry chicken is your entry-level price point (\$16–\$20) and produces excellent food cost margins. Both travel well and hold flavor for 30+ minutes after packing.
3	Oxtail — Your Premium Plate Slow-cooked oxtail with butter beans and white rice is the highest-value plate on your menu. Price: \$24–\$28. Food cost: \$8–\$10. The long cook time (3–4 hours minimum) limits how often you can offer it, which creates scarcity and excitement every time it appears on your weekly menu. Post oxtail availability on Friday evening and watch it sell out by Saturday morning.

4

Sides and Add-Ons — High Margin Items

Fried plantains (\$4–\$6), festival (\$3–\$4), fried dumplings (\$3–\$4), coleslaw (\$3–\$4). Sides have the highest profit margins on your menu — low food cost, fast to prepare, and they increase your average order value by \$6–\$12 per customer. Always suggest at least one side when a customer orders their main plate.

5

Desserts — Bonus Income

Black cake, rum cake, coconut drops, tamarind balls, sweet potato pudding. Caribbean desserts are almost impossible to find commercially and they generate extremely strong emotional responses from Caribbean customers. Price: \$5–\$10 per portion. Add one dessert to your weekly menu and watch it become the most talked-about item.

FOOD PHOTOGRAPHY — YOUR MOST IMPORTANT MARKETING TOOL

Before you sell a single plate, photograph your food properly. Natural window light. Clean white or wooden background. Sauce glistening. Steam if possible. Caribbean food photographs spectacularly when lit correctly. These photos are what you post in Facebook groups, WhatsApp, and Instagram. People eat with their eyes first. Your food photos are your menu, your advertisement, and your storefront simultaneously.

Staying Legal — Food Safety and Home Kitchen Rules

What you need to know before you sell your first plate.

Food safety is non-negotiable. Every US state has different rules about selling food made in a home kitchen — some allow it under cottage food laws, others require a commercial kitchen license, and some have specific exemptions for certain food types or sales volumes. Know your state's rules before you take your first order.

1

Cottage Food Laws — Check Your State

Most US states allow home cooks to sell certain types of food (baked goods, jams, candies) from a home kitchen without a commercial license — these are called cottage food laws. Ready-to-eat hot foods like jerk chicken and curry goat typically require a licensed commercial kitchen in most states. Search '[your state] cottage food law' to understand exactly what applies to your situation.

2

Food Handler's Certification — Get It First

A food handler's certification (ServSafe or state equivalent) costs \$15–\$40 and takes about 2 hours to complete online. It teaches you proper food storage temperatures, cross-contamination prevention, and safe food handling practices. Even if your state does not legally require it for home-based sales, having the certification makes you more trustworthy to customers and protects you from liability.

3

Commercial Kitchen Access — Your Legal Route

If your state requires a commercial kitchen for hot food sales, access one through a Caribbean church kitchen rental (\$75–\$150/day) or a shared commissary kitchen (\$15–\$35/hour). Cook your food there, package it, and deliver or sell it. The same Caribbean community networks that are your customers are also your path to affordable, legal kitchen access.

4

Safe Food Packaging and Temperature

Hot food must be kept above 140°F until served. Use insulated delivery bags for all hot food deliveries. Seal containers immediately after packing. Label every container with the dish name, date prepared, and your name. These practices protect your customers, protect your reputation, and protect you legally if a question ever arises about a food you sold.

YOUR BUSINESS WEBSITE — PERSONAL NOTE

A simple booking page makes you look professional and gets clients to take you seriously. Build yours fast with Lovable — an AI site builder where you describe what you want and it builds a professional site in minutes. No coding required. caribstream.io/lovable

Finding Your Customers in the Caribbean Community

Where to post, who to approach, and how to build a loyal weekly customer base.

Your first customers are already in your network. Every Caribbean family member, friend, church member, and community contact who has ever eaten your food — or heard someone talk about your food — is a potential customer. Start there before you post anywhere public.

1**Caribbean Facebook Groups — Your Weekly Menu Post**

Post your weekly menu in every Caribbean community Facebook group in your city every Friday: 'This Sunday: Jerk Chicken Plates (\$20), Curry Goat (\$22), Fried Plantains (\$5). Delivery available in [area]. Order by Saturday night. DM to place your order and pay via Zelle/CashApp.' Include your best food photograph. Post every single week without exception. Consistency builds customers.

2**WhatsApp Broadcast List — Your Direct Channel**

Build a WhatsApp broadcast list of everyone who has ever ordered from you or expressed interest. Send your weekly menu directly to this list every Friday at 6pm. A WhatsApp broadcast list of 50 Caribbean food lovers generates 15–25 orders every weekend without posting on any social media platform. This is your most valuable marketing channel.

3**Caribbean Church Events — Free Sampling**

Bring sample portions to Caribbean church events, community meetings, and cultural gatherings. Give samples freely. 'Try my jerk chicken — I am building a Caribbean food business and I want honest feedback.' A 50-person church gathering where you give free samples generates 8–15 orders the following weekend. The investment in samples pays back 5–10x in first-time orders.

4

TikTok and Instagram — Cooking Content

Film yourself cooking. The seasoning process. The browning. The steam rising from the pot. Caribbean cooking content performs exceptionally well on TikTok — 30-second clips of jerk chicken coming off the grill, oxtail bubbling in the pot, festival dropping into hot oil generate thousands of views organically from Caribbean diaspora viewers who share the content immediately. Include your order link in your bio.

Pricing, Portions, and Making Real Profit

How to price every dish so your food business actually makes money.

Most young food sellers make the mistake of pricing too low because they feel awkward charging what their food is worth. Caribbean community members will happily pay \$20 for a plate of genuine jerk chicken from someone they know and trust. Price your food at what it is worth — not at what feels comfortable. Underpricing is the number one reason good food businesses fail.

Dish	Food Cost	Sell Price	Profit Per Plate
Jerk chicken plate	\$5.50	\$20	\$14.50 (72%)
Curry goat plate	\$7.00	\$22	\$15.00 (68%)
Oxtail plate	\$9.00	\$26	\$17.00 (65%)
Curry chicken plate	\$4.50	\$18	\$13.50 (75%)
Fried plantains (side)	\$1.50	\$5	\$3.50 (70%)
Festival (2 pieces)	\$0.75	\$4	\$3.25 (81%)
Coconut drops (3 pcs)	\$1.00	\$6	\$5.00 (83%)

The Weekend Revenue Formula

20 plates per weekend at \$20 average = \$400 gross. Food cost at 30% = \$120. Net: \$280 per weekend. That is \$1,120 per month from one weekend cooking session. Add 5 side orders per plate at \$5 average: another \$100/weekend. Total: \$380 net per weekend, \$1,520/month. Add one catering event per month at \$800 net: \$2,320/month from a part-time food business.

Growing From Weekend Cook to Real Food Business

Catering, meal prep subscriptions, and the steps that scale your kitchen income.

Your weekend food sales are your proof of concept. Once you have 20 consistent weekly customers, you are ready to add the income streams that multiply your revenue without multiplying your cooking time proportionally.

1

Weekly Meal Prep Subscriptions

Offer a weekly subscription: 5 family-size portions for \$90/week, paid in advance every Sunday via Zelle or CashApp. Subscribers pick from your rotating weekly menu and receive their order every Sunday. 10 subscribers at \$90/week = \$900/week in guaranteed pre-paid revenue before you cook a single pot. This is the most powerful income stream in the Caribbean home food business.

2

Caribbean Community Catering

Church dinners, birthday parties, family reunions, graduation parties. A Caribbean family celebrating an event needs Caribbean food for 50–150 people. A catering booking for 60 people at \$18/head = \$1,080 from one event. Your food cost: \$350–\$400. Net: \$650–\$700 from one afternoon of cooking. Two catering bookings per month add \$1,300–\$1,400 to your monthly income.

3

DoorDash and Uber Eats — Expand Your Reach

Once you have commercial kitchen access, register your food business on DoorDash and Uber Eats. Your Caribbean menu items are unique on these platforms — most customers searching for Caribbean food in your city will find very limited options. A weekend on DoorDash with 10 additional orders at \$20 average adds \$200 in platform revenue on top of your direct sales.

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Grenada is called the Spice Isle — the world's second-largest nutmeg producer — because one community knew their land, knew their product, and turned that knowledge into a global export. Your kitchen is your spice isle. The knowledge you inherited from your Caribbean family is a product the world wants. Sell it with confidence.

Cook What You Know. Sell What People Love. Build Your Food Business.

The Caribbean community around you is hungry for what you already know how to cook. Every plate you sell is an advertisement. Every satisfied customer is a referral source. Every catering booking is a month's worth of weekend sales in one afternoon.

YOUR FIRST 30-DAY ACTION PLAN

Week 1 — Legal and safety setup

Look up your state's cottage food law. Complete your food handler's certification online. Identify your kitchen setup — home or commercial rental.

Week 2 — Menu and photography

Finalize your 4-dish menu. Cook each dish and photograph it with natural light. Build your WhatsApp broadcast list of 30+ potential customers.

Week 3 — First sales weekend

Post your menu in Caribbean Facebook groups Friday evening. Take orders via DM. Cook Sunday morning. Deliver or arrange pickup. Target 10 plates your first weekend.

Week 4 — Build the subscription base

Offer 5 customers a weekly meal prep subscription. Post your cooking content on TikTok. Build your booking page at caribstream.io/lovable.

RESOURCES AND LINKS

Business booking page (affiliate) — caribstream.io/lovable ServSafe food handler certification — servsafe.com Food packaging supplies — webstaurantstore.com or amazon.com Cottage food law by state — cottagefoodlaws.com DoorDash merchant signup — merchant.doordash.com Insulated delivery bags — amazon.com

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Caribbean kids building real businesses. Keeping roots. Building futures.

